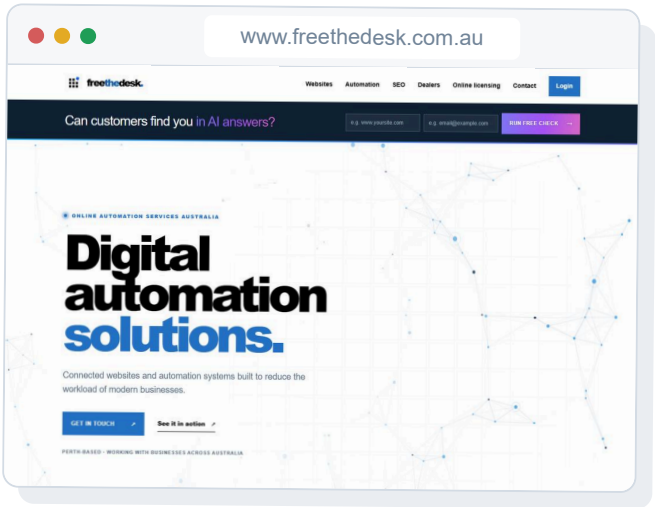


FreeTheDesk search report

Reporting period **29 August 2026 to 19 September 2026**
(22 days)

Three weeks of history, four clicks — every one from someone who already knew the name — while the only page earning impressions for the commercial terms has returned a 404 since 7 September, when a rename shipped without a redirect.



CLICKS, 29 AUG – 19 SEP

4

26 impressions, all-time

PAGES RANKING

9

one of them earned a click

AVERAGE POSITION

32.7

page four, site level

INDEXED PAGE
SERVING 404

1

/website-development-perth

00 — ABSTRACT

Twenty-two days of history and 26 impressions: this is a baseline, not a performance review. The four clicks are all people searching the business by name and finding the homepage at position 1.3. The finding that matters was caught by checking the site, not the data: /website-development-perth — the highest-impression page on the site, and the one answering the Perth web-development terms — has returned a 404 since a 7 September deploy renamed it to /website-development without a redirect, while Google still serves its cached copy as healthy. Add the redirect before the next recrawl, check nothing else was renamed the same way, give the error template its own metadata, build the dealer product pages out to real depth, and leave everything else alone until there is data to act on.

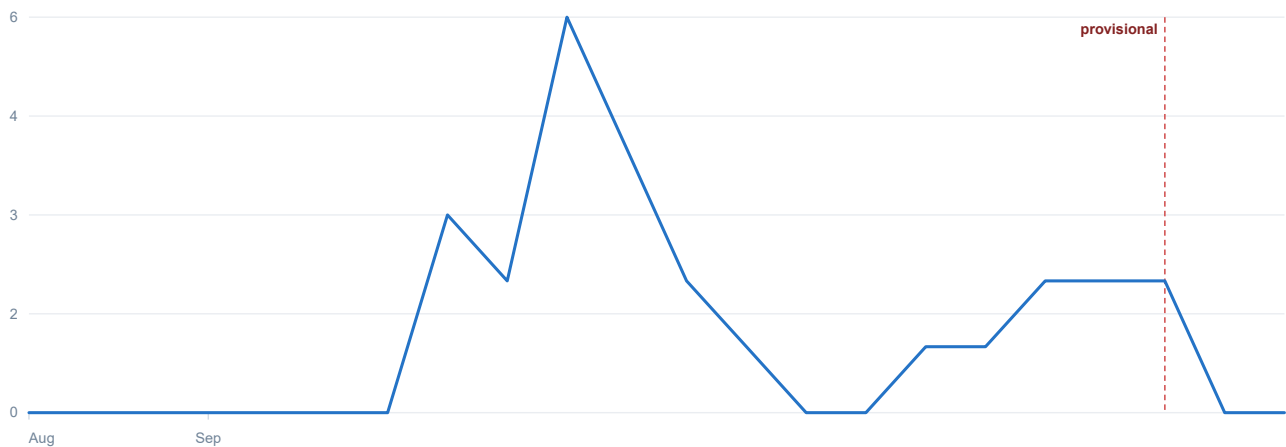
01 — WHERE THIS STARTS

This is a baseline, not a performance review

Search Console has twenty-two days of history for this property, beginning 29 August 2026: **26 impressions and 4 clicks**. No window in that is long enough to support a percentage change, so nothing here is a trend. What follows is the starting position, precise enough to be measured against later, plus one concrete fault found by checking the site rather than the data.

The whole recorded history

29 Aug – 19 Sep 2026, site tier, date-only series. The scale is the point



Search Console, date-only series — complete. A site this new is measured in single impressions per day

All four clicks went to the homepage, which sat at **position 1.3** across 10 impressions — a 40% click-through rate. That is the signature of people searching the business by name and finding it immediately. Every other page on the site earned impressions and no clicks.

Every page that ranked

29 Aug – 19 Sep 2026, page level, all countries

PAGE	IMPRESSIONS	CLICKS	POSITION	LIVE STATUS
/	10	4	1.3	200
/website-development-perth	15	0	28.9	404
/automation	10	0	27.5	200
/dealership-website-builder	9	0	14.6	200
/licensing	6	0	5.2	200
/portfolio/scooter-shop	5	0	21.8	200
/legal/dealer-subscription-terms	4	0	7.0	200
/seo	3	0	2.0	200
/legal/privacy	1	0	5.0	200

Search Console page tier; live status from a rendered fetch on 19 September 2026

WHAT TWENTY-SIX IMPRESSIONS CAN AND CANNOT SUPPORT

A single impression moves any rate on this page by several points. Positions drawn from three or four impressions describe those three or four searches and nothing wider. Treat every figure in this report as a recorded starting value, not as an estimate of how the site performs.

02 — THE FINDING

The page ranking for the commercial terms is a 404, and Google does not know yet

/website-development-perth drew **15 impressions** in the period, more than any page on the site including the homepage, at an average position of 28.9. It is the page that answers "perth website development", "custom web development perth" and "custom web design perth" — the terms the web development side of the business is sold on.

It returns **HTTP 404**. The URL serves the site's error template: an `h1` reading "404", the line "This page could not be found", and — because the template inherits the site's default metadata — the homepage's title and meta description.

Google's view of the same URL, read through the URL Inspection API on 19 September, still reports it *Submitted and indexed*, last crawled successfully on **5 September 2026**. Two things follow: the page broke on or after 5 September, and Google is still showing searchers a cached copy it believes is healthy — which is exactly what the 15 impressions are.

The deploy history settles when and why. A production deploy at 08:11 on **7 September** renamed the page to `/website-development` — same content, de-localised — and updated the sitemap to the new path in the same commit. What it did not do is redirect the old URL. So the address Google knows, ranks and still shows to searchers has served the error template ever since; the break is not a removal or a regression but the missing half of a rename.

WHAT THIS COSTS RIGHT NOW

Very little in clicks, because at position 28.9 almost nobody was reaching it anyway. The cost is ahead: when Google next recrawls, a 404 on a submitted URL drops it from the index, and the site loses its only ranking page for its highest-value commercial terms. The fix is worth making before that recrawl, not after.

03 — A QUIRK WORTH READING

The site's own pages appear together in the same results

Grouped by date, the property recorded 26 impressions; grouped by page, **63**. On most properties the page tier is the smaller number, because Search Console withholds the URL for a large share of searches. Here it is 2.4 times larger, and that is reproducible against the API.

The arithmetic is simple: a date-level impression counts one appearance in one set of results; a page-level impression counts each URL shown. When two or three FreeTheDesk URLs surface in the same results — likely, on a nine-page site describing adjacent services in similar language — that is one site impression and several page impressions. Not a fault, but page-tier counts describe appearances, not searches, and the tiers must not be added or compared.

The three attribution tiers do not agree, and the direction is unusual

29 Aug – 19 Sep 2026, all countries

GROUPED BY	IMPRESSIONS	CLICKS	WHAT IT COUNTS
Date only	26	4	Searches where the site appeared. The complete series.
Page	63	4	URL appearances, so one search can count more than once.
Query	13	0	Searches Google was willing to name — half the total.

Date only — searches the site appeared in

Page — URL appearances

Query — searches Google would name

26

63

13

Search Console Search Analytics API, verified directly against all three groupings

The query tier is the constraint on everything in the next section. Google named the search term for 13 of 26 impressions and none of the 4 clicks. Every query-level statement in this report covers that half.

04 — WHAT RANKS

The best-placed pages are the ones with nothing to sell

Ordering the nine ranked pages by position rather than by impressions inverts the site. /seo sits at position 2.0, /legal/privacy at 5.0, /licensing at 5.2 and /legal/dealer-subscription-terms at 7.0 — a subscription terms page on the first page of results. Meanwhile /dealership-website-builder, a product page, averages 14.6, and /automation 27.5.

The honest reading is that the well-placed pages match long, specific, low-competition phrasing — a legal document ranks seventh because barely anything competes for its exact words. That is not authority. But it is evidence the site is fully crawled and indexed, which for a three-week-old property is the thing that had to be true.

Where the named queries do reach the commercial terms, the positions are page three and four: "custom web design perth" at 20.0, "custom web development perth" at 31.0, "perth website development" at 37.5. One query — "custom web design perth" — is inside striking distance, and it is the single closest the site comes to competing for work.

Every named query

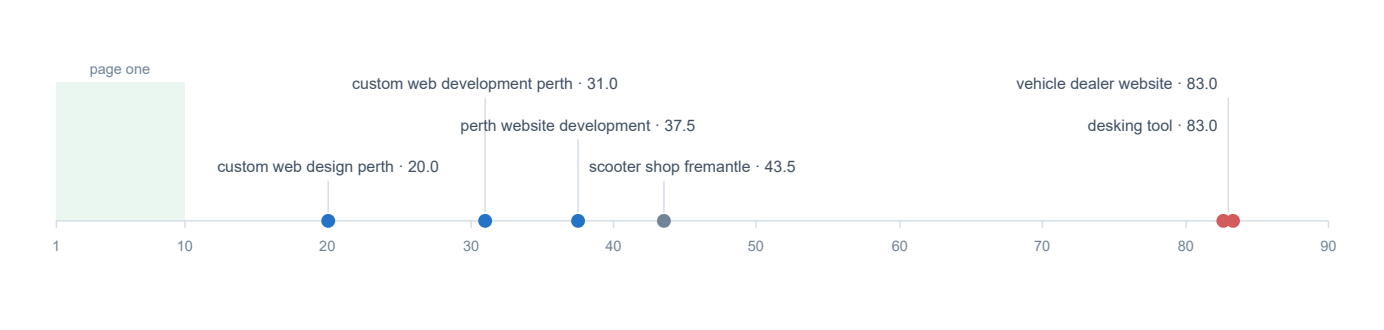
29 Aug – 19 Sep 2026, query tier — 13 of 26 impressions

QUERY	IMPRESSIONS	POSITION	READS AS
perth website development	4	37.5	Web development, the money term
desking tool	3	83.0	Dealer systems, product category
custom web development perth	2	31.0	Web development
scooter shop fremantle	2	43.5	A client's brand, via the portfolio
custom web design perth	1	20.0	Closest to competitive
vehicle dealer website	1	83.0	Dealer systems

Search Console query tier, all countries

Where every named query sits

Average position per query; the green band is the first page of results



Search Console query tier. Blue: the Perth web-development terms. Red: the dealer product terms, both past position 80. Grey: a client's brand, via the portfolio

Two of the six are for the dealer product and both sit past position 80. Neither "desking tool" nor "vehicle dealer website" has a page written against it: /dealership-website-builder is 455 words, the shortest page on the site and a third the length of /automation.

The portfolio page is competing in a client's own search results

"scooter shop fremantle" produced 2 impressions at position 43.5, served by /portfolio/scooter-shop — the case study for Scootershop, a separate property in this series. At position 43 it is harmless and it is not demand for FreeTheDesk. It is recorded because the failure mode it points at is real: a well-optimised case study can end up ranking above the client on the client's own name. Nothing suggests that is happening, and it is cheap to watch.

06 — SINCE THE LAST REPORT

Nothing carries forward

This is the first report for the property. There is no inherited recommendation ledger, no running experiment and no previous figure to attribute a movement to. The live check recorded all nine URLs for the first time, so there is no site-change comparison either — what changed since the last check is, for now, everything.

07 — WHAT TO DO

Recommendations

1 Redirect /website-development-perth to its renamed self

ID: FIX-WDP-404

PRIORITY 1

COST: LOW

The deploy history removes the ambiguity: the page was renamed to /website-development deliberately on 7 September and the sitemap was updated in the same deploy — the only missing piece is a permanent redirect from the old URL. One rule, shipped before the next recrawl, and the index standing transfers instead of dying stranded. Worth watching afterwards: the old, Perth-qualified URL held the site's only impressions for the Perth web-development terms, and whether the de-localised page keeps them is exactly what the experiment in section 08 reads. Evidence: section 02.

2 Check nothing else was renamed without a redirect

ID: SITEMAP-404-AUDIT

PRIORITY 2

COST: LOW

The current sitemap is clean — the 7 September deploy got it right — but the fault class is a rename that updates the sitemap and forgets the redirect, and that leaves no trace in the current sitemap at all. The URLs Google already knows are the exposure: check every URL Search Console has ever recorded an impression for still resolves, after any batch of renames. Nine pages today; cheap forever. Evidence: section 02.

3 Give the 404 template its own title and metadata

ID: ERROR-PAGE-METADATA

PRIORITY 3

COST: LOW

The error page currently inherits the homepage title and meta description, so a broken URL presents to a crawler as a legitimate page. That makes faults like the one above harder to spot from the outside and slower for Google to act on. A distinct title and a `noindex` directive on the error template make a 404 read as a 404.

4 Build the dealer product pages out to match the service pages

ID: DEALER-PAGE-DEPTH

PRIORITY 4

COST: MEDIUM

Both dealer-side queries sit past position 80, and `/dealership-website-builder` is 455 words against 1,661 for `/seo` and 1,050 for `/automation`. The two pages that rank respectably are the two with substance on them. This is the clearest lever the site has, and it is a content job rather than a technical one. Evidence: section 04.

5 Leave the rest alone until there is data

ID: HOLD-FOR-DATA

PRIORITY 5

COST: LOW

Twenty-six impressions cannot distinguish a page that is underperforming from one that has not been seen. Optimising against these figures means optimising against noise, and it would also destroy the baseline this report exists to establish. The useful work over the next quarter is publishing and fixing, not tuning.

08 — WHAT TO TEST

Experiments

One proposed, none running.

Proposed

HYPOTHESIS	BASELINE	READ ON
wdp-restore — a permanent redirect from /website-development-perth to /website-development transfers its index standing: the Perth web-development impressions reappear on the new URL rather than vanishing at the next recrawl.	15 impressions, position 28.9, 0 clicks, 29 Aug – 19 Sep 2026	2026-11-14

Baseline from the page tier for this period

The read date is set far enough out to clear a recrawl cycle on a site Google currently visits about fortnightly. An earlier look shows whether the URL still resolves, which is worth knowing, but it does not answer the question.

09 — METHOD AND LIMITS

What was measured, and what this report cannot tell you

Measured. Every figure comes from the Google Search Console Search Analytics API for `https://www.freethedesk.com.au/`, web search, all countries, stored daily from 29 August 2026. Site totals use the date-only series, which is the complete one. Page and query figures are separate tiers and are labelled as such wherever they appear. All nine URLs the report describes were fetched and rendered with headless Chrome on 19 September 2026, and Google's own index view of the same nine was read through the URL Inspection API the same day.

No country filter. Twenty-four of twenty-six impressions are Australian; the remaining two are not excluded, because at this volume a filter removes rows without improving a figure.

Seasonality cannot be separated from cause. Twenty-two days of history, no prior year. Nothing in this report should be read as a trend, and no movement in it can be attributed to a season, a change on the site, or anything else.

Google named the query for half the impressions and none of the clicks. Section 04 describes 13 of 26 impressions. The other half were searches Google declined to disclose, and they may not resemble the ones it did.

The page tier overcounts here. Page-level impressions exceed site-level by 2.4 times because one search can show more than one of the site's URLs. Page impressions are appearances, not searches.

One render in the first pass was wrong, and the check was repeated. The first live pass recorded /licensing with no title and no body text. Fetched directly, the page serves 847 words and a correct title; the render had failed rather than the page being empty. The check was re-run and the corrected record is what this

report and its stored baseline use. A rendered fetch is evidence, not proof, and a single failed render looks exactly like a broken page.

There is no analytics. Search Console carries no sessions, no conversions and no revenue, so nothing here can say what a click was worth or what happened after it. Every priority above is ranked on search evidence and commercial judgement, not on outcomes. Google Analytics was removed from this site and no replacement is collecting; restoring it is the single change that would most improve the next report.

The 404's origin is established. The live check found the URL returning 404; the deploy history (Vercel, read 20 September, after the period closed) shows why: a 7 September deploy renamed the page and updated the sitemap without redirecting the old URL. What deploy evidence cannot show is whether an earlier rename did the same thing to a URL that never earned impressions — recommendation 2 covers that.

PROVENANCE

Property	https://www.freethedesk.com.au/
Market	ALL COUNTRIES
Search type	web
Reporting period	29 August 2026 to 19 September 2026 (22 days)
Data through	19 September 2026
Provisional from	17 September 2026
Stored history	29 August 2026 onward, 22 days
Report version	r1
Engine / ruleset / config	1.4.0 / 1.1.0 / 8046c668eee3
Extracted	2026-09-20 01:52:36 UTC

SOURCES

SOURCE	STATUS	DETAIL
Google Search Console Search Analytics API	present	Property https://www.freethedesk.com.au/, all countries, type=web. Stored daily from 2026-08-29 to 2026-09-19.
Live site checks	present	9 URLs rendered and recorded 2026-09-19T15:22:04+00:00, with Google's index view of the same URLs. Full record in site.json.
Business context recorded by the owner	present	5 standing fact(s) in freethedesk.context.md. These are things the data cannot show; they constrain what this report may conclude.
Analytics (sessions, conversions, revenue)	absent	Search Console has no revenue and no post-click behaviour, so every opportunity below is ranked by clicks, not by what a click is worth.

Generated by freetheplatform.searchconsole 1.4.0, ruleset 1.1.0, property configuration 8046c668eee3. Figures come from the Google Search Console Search Analytics API and are reproducible from the stored snapshot for this property. Search Console reports two to three days behind; anything after 17 September 2026 is provisional.